Teaching notes

This activity could be used with a whole class as a starter or a plenary. The class could be split into teams or students could have mini whiteboards which they hold up when they have decided on an answer.

Read the statements out one at a time. If students guess the object after one clue they get five points, after the second clue they get four points, etc.

If the game is played in groups, each student could be given a set of statements to test the others in the group.

As an extension students could write up with their own five statements about an object and then play the game with a partner.

Element	Description	Points
Hydrogen	At room temperature it is tasteless, odourless and colourless.	5
	It is the most common element found in our universe.	4
	It is highly flammable.	3
	It is the first element on the periodic table.	2
	Its chemical symbol is H.	1
Oxygen	Ozone is an allotrope (a different form) of it.	5
	When highly concentrated, it promotes fast combustion.	4
	It is released by photosynthesising plants.	3
	It is a very reactive element that easily forms compounds, such as oxides.	2
	It is a gas.	1
Carbon	A form known as ‘buckminsterfullerene’ has recently been discovered.	5
	It is one of the basic components of life forms on Earth.	4
	It may be found naturally in three forms, amorphous, graphite and diamond.	3
	It is one of the atoms present in limestone molecules.	2
	Its symbol is C.	1
Bromine	It is the only liquid, non- metallic element at room temperature.	5
	It is red-brown in colour.	4
	Its vapour is an unpleasant irritant.	3
	It is a halogen.	2
	It has the chemical symbol Br.	1
Potassium	It is a metal.	5
	It is one of the most reactive metals.	4
	It is essential for plant growth.	3

	It is soft and can be easily cut with a knife.	2
	It has the chemical symbol K.	1

Chlorine	It is a gas.	5
	It is yellowish-green in colour.	4
	It combines with sodium atoms to make common salt.	3
	It was used to gas troops in the First World War.	2
	It has the chemical symbol Cl.	1
Helium	It is colourless and odourless.	5
	It is very unreactive.	4
	It is lighter than air.	3
	It is a noble gas.	2
	It is used in MRI scans and balloons.	1
Gold	It is a good conductor of heat.	5
	It is very unreactive.	4
	It is very malleable.	3
	Different metals may be alloyed to it, which can change its colour.	2
	It is metallic yellow in colour.	1
Magnesium	It is found in plant chlorophyll.	5
	It burns with a very bright light.	4
	It is a metal.	3
	It reacts with oxygen to form a white powder oxide.	2
	Its chemical symbol is Mg.	1
Mercury	It is silvery white in colour.	5
	It is liquid at room temperature.	4
	It is sometimes known as ‘quicksilver’.	3
	It has the symbol Hg.	2
	It is used in thermometers.	1